## EL SALVADOR* (5 February)

**Harvesting of 2003 second season coarse grain, paddy and bean crops has been completed. The aggregate output of maize, the main cereal, is expected to be 610 000 tonnes, which is above the last five years' average. By contrast, the 2003 paddy production was estimated at only 28 000 tonnes, reflecting reduced plantings.**

**The crisis of the coffee sector continues to affect large sections of the rural population with negative impact on the nutritional situation. Food and non-food assistance continues to be delivered by the international community, in particular in the western departments of Ahuachapan, Sonsonate and La Libertad, targeting vulnerable groups such as children under five and expectant and nursing mothers.**

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